take 'will or would' as verbs in the question tag.

e.g. Please, bring me a glass of water, **would you**? (polite request)

Always follow the traffic rules, **would you**? (obligation)

Join us for lunch tomorrow, **will you**? (invitation)

Don't ever meddle with my papers, **will you**? (warning)

❖ The pronoun 'they' is used if the subject of the sentence refers to people or animals or things in plural.

e.g. **The young should** learn to take up responsibilities, shouldn't they?

The toys in the box **are not** new, **are they**?

❖ Though the subjects 'someone, somebody, anyone, anybody, no one, nobody, everything, everyone and everybody' are singular in meaning, the pronoun 'they' is used in the question tag.

e.g. **Nobody has** arrived yet, **have they**?

Everyone will attend the party, **won't they**?

❖ The pronoun 'it' is used in the question tag when the subject of the statement is:

- a thing or an animal in singular form
- 'Something', 'Anything' or 'Nothing'
- 'This' or 'That'

e.g. **The peacock is** the national bird of India, **isn't it**?

The blue frock was more expensive than the pink one, **wasn't it**?

Something has gone wrong in the circuit, **hasn't it**?

This is not your dad's car, **is it**?

❖ When the statements begin with 'There', the same is used as the subject of the question tags too.

e.g. **There is not** much time left, **is there**?

There was a pond beside the temple, **wasn't there**?

❖ The words 'hardly, scarcely, rarely, barely and seldom' are considered as negatives and therefore take positive question tags.

e.g. We **rarely visit** our native town, **do we**?

Ajith **seldom speaks** in English, **does he**?

❖ Statements having 'a little' or 'a few' are positive and therefore they take a negative tag. Statements having 'little' or 'few' are negative and therefore take a positive tag.

e.g. **A few** germs can be viewed through this microscope, **can't they**?

Little do your parents know about this problem, **do they**?

❖ The appropriate form of 'be' is used, if the statement contains a 'be' verb. The 'be' forms 'is, are, was, were' are repeated in the tag. The verb **am** in the statement takes **aren't** as its tag; **ain't**

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